

LAB MANUAL



COM 682

Faculty of Computing, Engineering and The
Built Environment

COM682 – Lab 04-b

Use of Wireframes

Contents

1. Wireframes.....	3
Figma Wireframing Tutorial	3
1 Getting Started with Figma	3
Create Your Figma Account	3
Create a New Design File	4

2	Understanding the Figma Interface	4
3	Essential Tools for Wireframing.....	5
4	Creating Your First Wireframe	6
	Step 4.1: Set Up Your Canvas.....	6
	Step 4.2: Create the Header	6
	Example:.....	7
	Step 4.3: Create the Hero Section	7
	Example: Hero Section	7
	MAIN HEADING	7
	Step 4.4: Create the Gallery Section.....	8
	Example: Gallery Section.....	8
	Gallery Title.....	8
	Step 4.5: Create the About Section	8
	Step 4.6: Create the Contact Form	8
	Step 4.7: Create the Footer.....	8
5	Organizing Your Wireframe	9
	Use the Layers Panel	9
	Create Groups	9
6	Adding Annotations.....	9
	How to Add Annotations.....	9
	Example Annotation	9
7	Saving and Sharing Your Work.....	9
	Sharing Your Wireframe	10
	Student Practice Activity.....	10
	Option 1: Personal Portfolio.....	10
	Option 2: Local Business Website.....	10
	Option 3: Event Website	10
2.	Review the sample wireframe.....	11

1. Wireframes

Figma Wireframing Tutorial

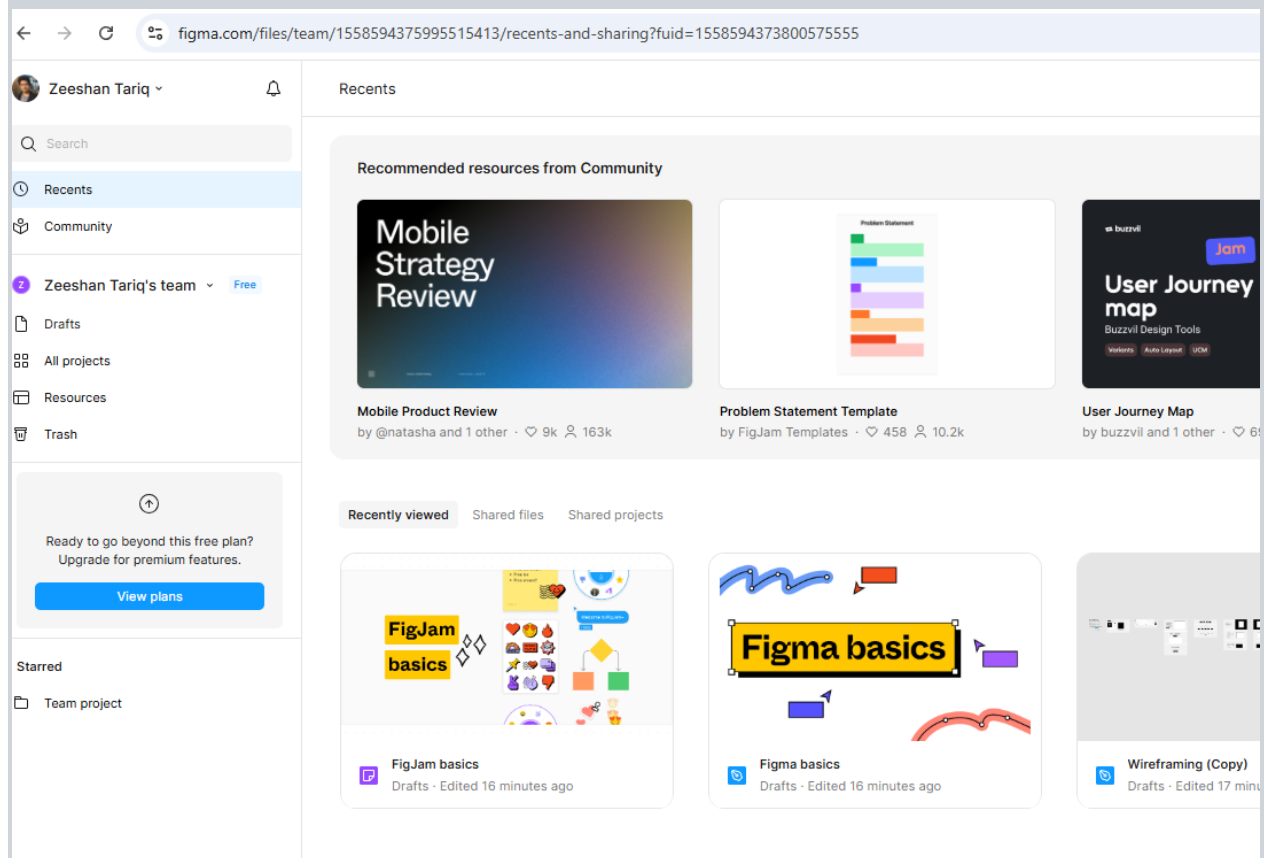
Beginner's guide to creating your first website wireframe

1 Getting Started with Figma

Figma is a free, web-based design tool that's perfect for creating wireframes. Let's get set up:

Create Your Figma Account

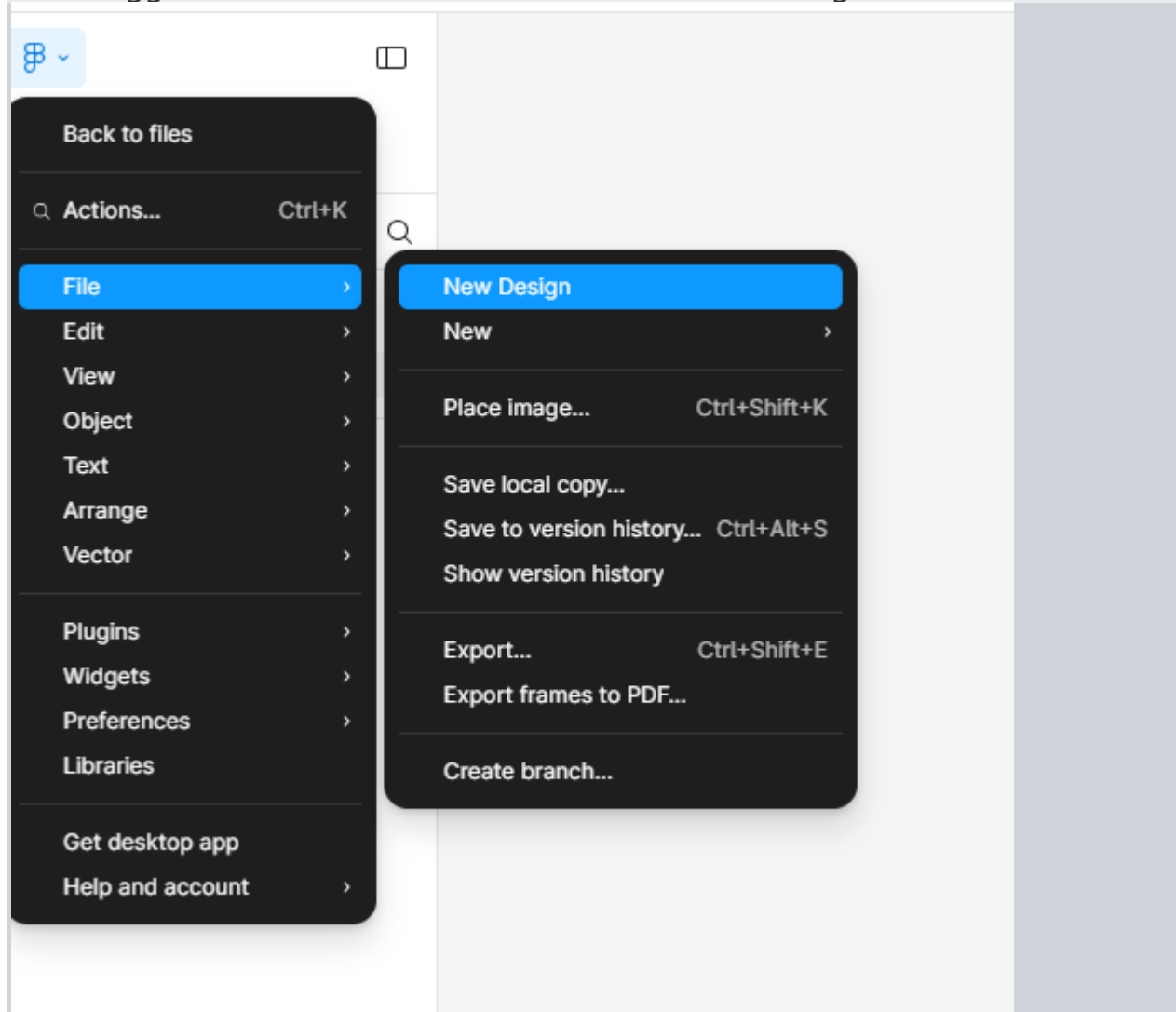
Go to **figma.com** and sign up for a free account.



Pro Tip: Use your school email - sometimes there are educational benefits!

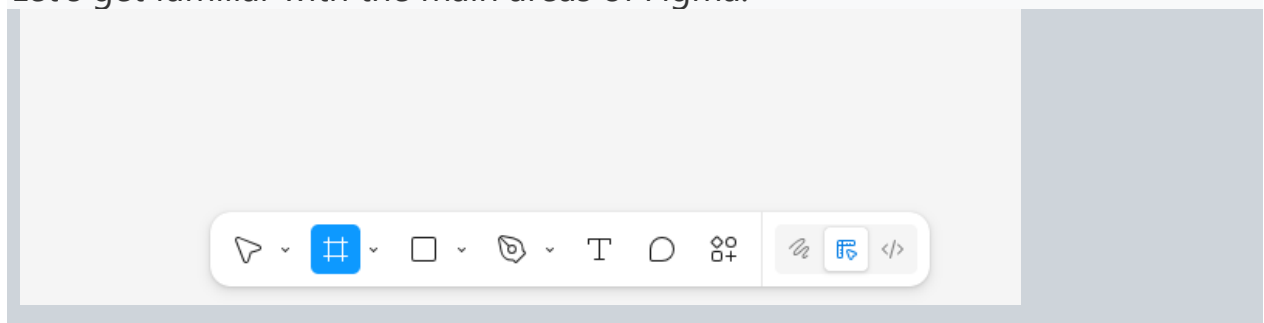
Create a New Design File

Once logged in, click the "New" button and select "Design File".



2 Understanding the Figma Interface

Let's get familiar with the main areas of Figma:



Toolbar

Top-left with selection, shapes, text, and more



Properties Panel

Right side with design properties



Layers Panel

Left side showing all elements



Canvas

Central area where you design

Remember: You can always undo with **Ctrl+Z** (Windows) or **Cmd+Z** (Mac) if you make a mistake!

3 Essential Tools for Wireframing

We'll mainly use these tools for wireframing:

F

Frame Tool

Creates containers for your designs

Shortcut: F

R

Rectangle Tool

Creates boxes and shapes

Shortcut: R

T

Text Tool

Adds text to your design

Shortcut: T

O

Ellipse Tool

Creates circles and ovals

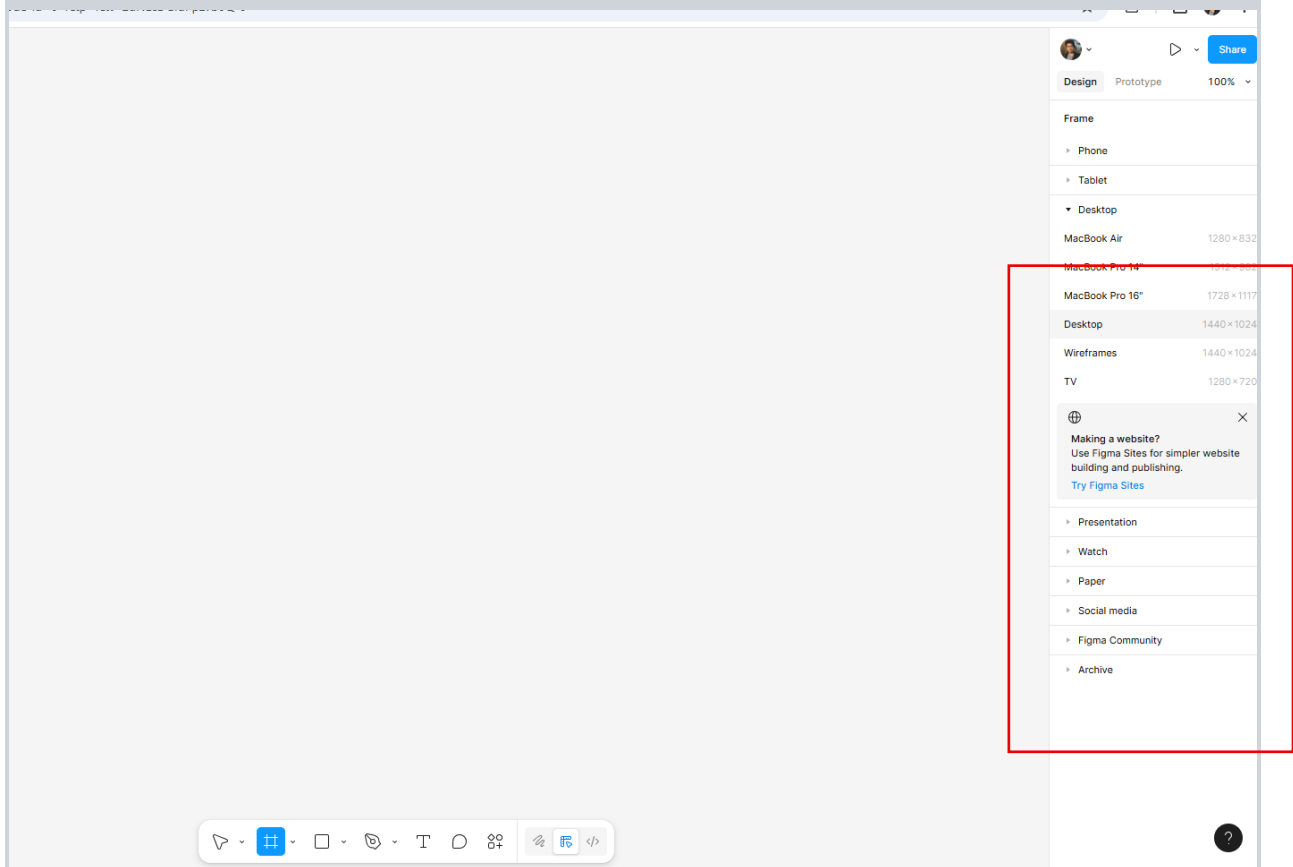
Shortcut: O

4 Creating Your First Wireframe

Let's create a wireframe for a simple website. We'll build a photography portfolio site.

Step 4.1: Set Up Your Canvas

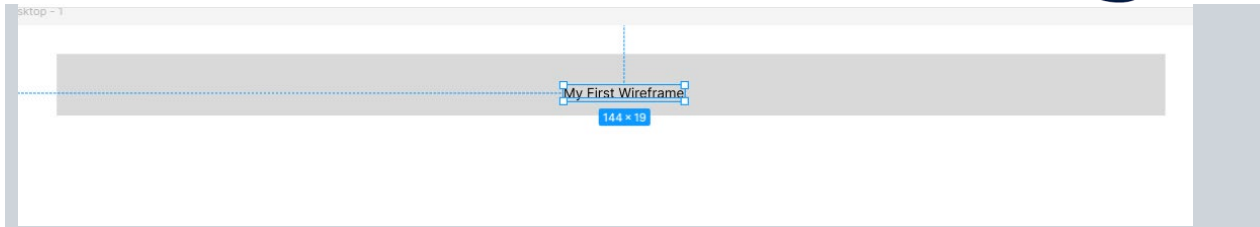
Select the Frame Tool **F** and choose "Desktop" (1440x1024) from the right panel.



Step 4.2: Create the Header

Use the Rectangle Tool **R** to draw a header bar at the top.

1. Draw a rectangle across the top (about 80px tall)
2. Use the Text Tool **T** to add a logo on the left
3. Add navigation links (Home, Gallery, About, Contact) on the right



LOGO

Home

Gallery

About

Contact

Step 4.3: Create the Hero Section

This is the large banner area at the top of the page.

1. Draw a large rectangle below the header
2. Add a heading using the Text Tool
3. Add a subheading or description
4. Create two buttons using rectangles with text

[Image: Hero section creation]

MAIN HEADING

Description text goes here

Button 1

Button 2

Design Tip: Use different shades of gray to show importance. Darker elements attract more attention.

Step 4.4: Create the Gallery Section

We'll create a grid of image placeholders.

1. Add a section title using the Text Tool
2. Use the Rectangle Tool to create a grid of 6 squares (2 rows of 3)
3. Add labels below each image placeholder

[Image: Gallery section creation]

Gallery Title

Description of the gallery

Image 1

Image 2

Image 3

Image 4

Image 5

Image 6

Step 4.5: Create the About Section

This section will have text and an image side by side.

1. Draw two rectangles next to each other
2. Add text content to the left rectangle
3. Add an image placeholder to the right rectangle

Step 4.6: Create the Contact Form

We'll add a simple contact form.

1. Add a section title
2. Create text fields using rectangles (Name, Email, Message)
3. Add a submit button

Step 4.7: Create the Footer

The footer goes at the very bottom of the page.

1. Draw a rectangle across the bottom
2. Divide it into columns using guides or separate rectangles
3. Add copyright information

[Image: Footer creation]

5 Organizing Your Wireframe

Keeping your Figma file organized is important!

Use the Layers Panel

Rename your layers so you can find them easily.

[Image: Layers panel with renamed layers]

Create Groups

Select multiple elements and press **Ctrl+G** to group them.

[Image: Grouped elements in layers panel]

Organization Tip: Name your groups logically like "Header", "Hero Section", "Gallery" to stay organized.

6 Adding Annotations

Annotations help explain your design decisions.

How to Add Annotations

1. Use the Text Tool to add notes
2. Draw arrows pointing to specific elements
3. Use different colors for different types of notes

[Image: Annotated wireframe example]

Navigation Element

Note: This navigation should stick to the top when scrolling

7 Saving and Sharing Your Work

Figma automatically saves your work, but let's make sure you can share it.

Sharing Your Wireframe

Click the "Share" button in the top-right and adjust settings.

[Image: Share dialog in Figma]

Sharing Tip: Set permissions to "Anyone with the link can view" when sharing with classmates or teachers.

Student Practice Activity

Now it's your turn! Create a wireframe for one of these websites:

Option 1: Personal Portfolio

- Header with your name and navigation
- Hero section with your photo and bio
- Projects gallery
- Skills section
- Contact information

Option 2: Local Business Website

- Header with logo and navigation
- Services offered
- Customer testimonials
- Contact form and location
- Footer with business hours

Option 3: Event Website

- Event name and date prominently displayed
- Schedule of activities
- Speaker or performer information
- Registration form
- Venue location and details

Challenge: Try creating both a desktop and mobile version of your wireframe!

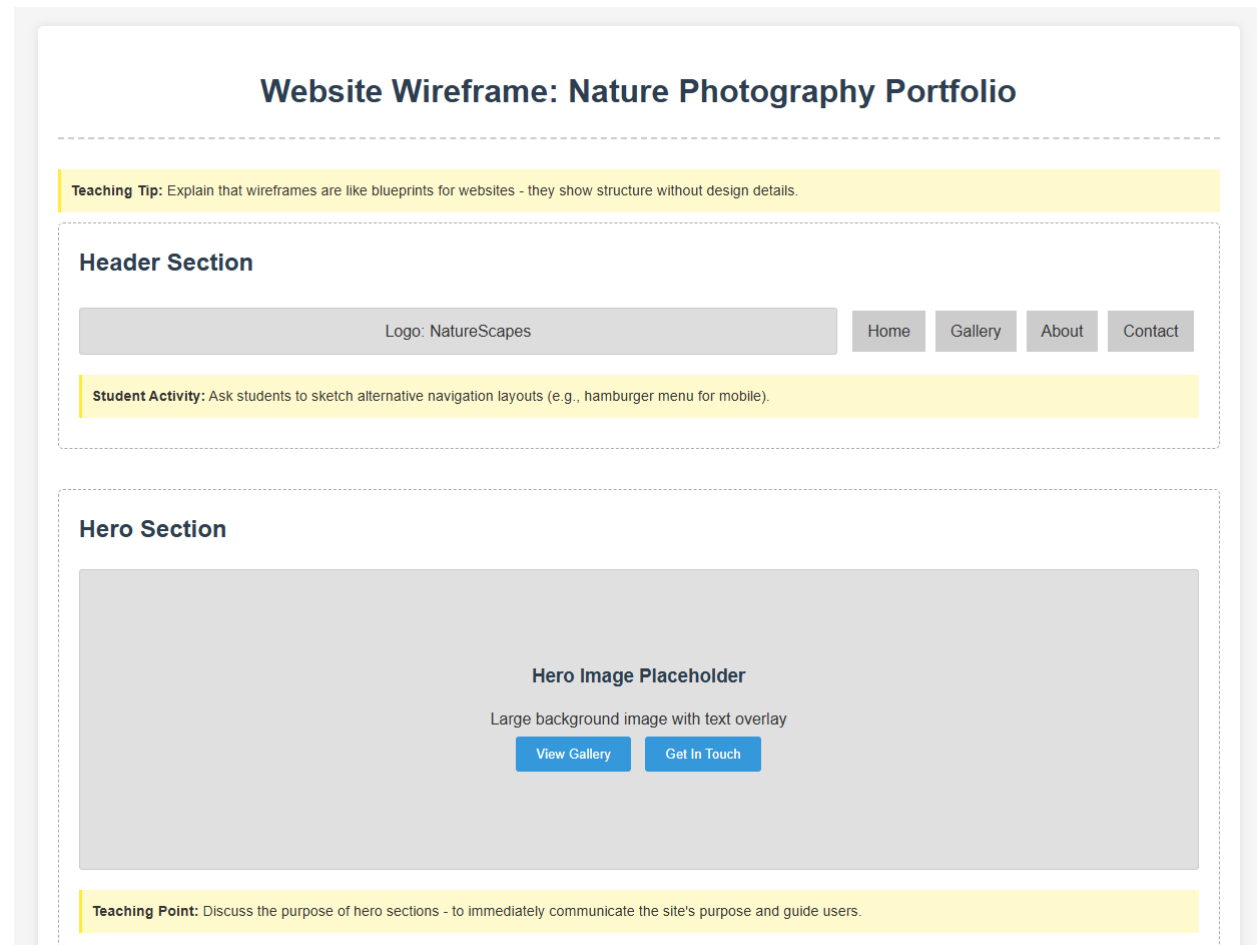
2. Review the sample wireframe

In other lab of week-4, you have uploaded a sample static website.

See the wireframe of that website here:



Lab04_Wireframe.html



***For CW1, provide such wireframe for your web application.**